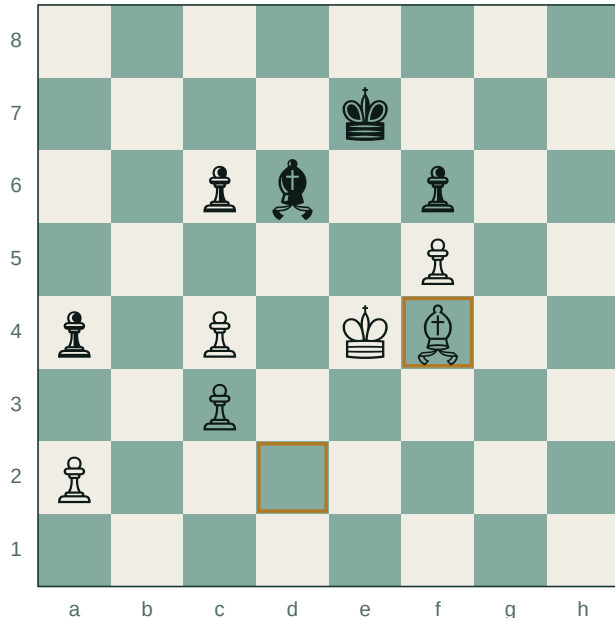


Bishop-ending decisions: Black, move 49

Bishop-ending decisions

Black to move



Previous move: 49.Bxf4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

49...Bxf4 50. Kxf4 Kd6 51. Ke4 Kc5 52. Kd3 a3

49...Bxf4 The bishop captures the bishop on f4. Recorded reply: **50.Kxf4**.

50...Kd6 The king moves from e7 to d6. Recorded reply: **51.Ke4**.

51...Kc5 The king moves from d6 to c5. Recorded reply: **52.Kd3**.

52...a3 The pawn moves from a4 to a3.

At the end, nominal material is White 4 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +0:** the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Same-colored and opposite-colored bishop endings have different tendencies, but neither label replaces calculation of the actual pawn races.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A bishop ending depends on diagonal access, pawn color, king activity, and promotion squares. Tactics can arise when a bishop must perform two defensive jobs.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the bishop's line to each target and identify pawns that can break its coverage or force it to move.

The defending king is on e4. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.